Ethan Charalambous

Product designer

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About

I am... a final-year product designer who learns by making. Most of what I know came from prototypes that didn't work and the fixes that followed.

I'm most proud of... the Potting Cup: around 30 prototypes, 12 finished units in users' hands, and a patent application in progress.

Projects

VisNav — Final-year project

University of Sussex · 2026 - present

Haptic wristbands and an app that give visually impaired sailors left and right steering cues. Before building any electronics, I tested the idea at Blind Sailing Week with a low-fidelity touch prototype and a sailor who is profoundly deaf and severely visually impaired. I've interviewed six visually impaired sailors aged 19 to 82 and surveyed 45 Sailing Vision Trust crew. Now building the ESP32 electronics, CAD and 3D-printed prototypes.

Potting Cup — Self-initiated project

2025 - present

An accessible scoop-and-press potting tool for gardeners with arthritis, weak grip or other hand conditions. I made around 30 prototypes to fit hands from the 5th to the 95th percentile, then gave 12 finished units to gardeners and volunteers to test, including people with arthritis. Patent application in progress.

Live industry briefs

University of Sussex

Stanley Black & Decker (modular ceiling garden), Bird & Blend Tea Co. (temperature-controlled teapot), Schofield Watch Company (capsule watch box) and a team running-belt brand.

Experience

Tremlett & Turner — Product designer (work experience)

Bristol · May 2025 · 2 months

Shop-fit design and hands-on fitting with interior specialists. Learned tolerances, assembly and real-world build constraints.

Pomeroy Studio — Work experience

Singapore · April 2024 · 6 weeks

Architecture practice. Joined the Pakistan launch of the Greens Enclave eco-community.

December19 — Work experience

London · May 2023 · 2 months

Media planning and buying agency, working on live client briefs.

Freelance and part-time

2019 - 2024

Freelance logos for Maverick Strength Gym and Pomeroy Technology. Tennis coach assistant at Broxbourne Tennis Club for 3 years (LTA Level 1).

Education

University of Sussex — BSc Product Design

2023 - 2027 · with a foundation year in Design and Business · Predicted high 2:1

Richard Hale School

2016 - 2023

A Level Product Design (B). 8 GCSEs, including Grade 8 in Design and Technology.

Awards

Global Design Challenge winner, 2025. A bamboo farm to clean the Jukskei River in Johannesburg.

Product Design Award, 2021 and 2023. Richard Hale School.

Skills

Design User interviews and testing, ergonomics, CAD, rendering, UI design

Making Workshop and mechanical prototyping, 3D printing (Bambu Lab), Arduino and ESP32

Software SolidWorks, Onshape, Blender, Figma, Illustrator, InDesign, Photoshop

Interests Sailing, gym, tennis, padel, rugby, gardening